



Cover story **Heroes and Survivors**

Heavy METTLE

Mumbai didn't buckle under. From constables to tourists, the city's unlikely heroes swung into action as 26/11 unfolded. INDIA TODAY salutes them.

By Malini Bhupta, Aditi Pai, Swati Mathur and Nikita Jain



NAGAPPA MALI and HEMANT BAWDHANKAR, 54 and 44

Senior Police Inspector, Assistant
Police Inspector and Constables
LOCATION: Girgaum Chowpatty

**"We did not have weapons,
but had the guts to fight"**

The Mumbai Police needn't worry about obesity affecting the performance of its force. If anything, it was the collective weight of a dozen constables that helped to nab Mohammad Ajmal Mohammad Amir Kasab, one of the two terrorists who struck at Chhatrapati Shivaji Terminus (CST) and Cama Hospital. The unfinished agenda of the head of Mumbai's Anti-terrorism Squad Hemant Karkare and encounter specialist Vijay Salaskar was closed by them along with Senior Police Inspector Nagappa Mali.

The D.B. Marg Police overcame AK-47-toting terrorists with just 9 mm pistols and lathis. Says Mali: "We didn't have weapons but we had guts." As Kasab and another terrorist left Cama Hospital in Karkare's Qualis after



killing him, Salaskar and Additional Commissioner of Police Ashok Kamte, they kept firing till they reached Girgaum Chowpatty. Mali and his deputy Hemant Bawdhankar had barricaded the road. When the terrorists reached them, they were made to surrender. Kasab fell to the ground and began firing but the police overpowered him as some constables fell on him and tied him, while the other was shot.

SHRIYA PATIL SHINDE
**BAWDHANKAR
(CENTRE) AND
MALI (RIGHT)**